

JETPAKT · ONE-TIME SCAN

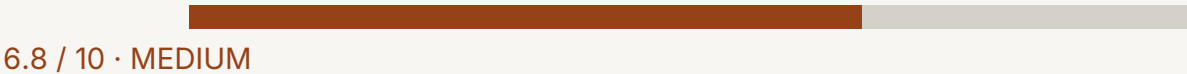
City, O' City

206 E 13th Ave · Denver, CO 80203 (Capitol Hill)

Scan generated April 18, 2026

3.4	30%	1456	-1.03
Public rating	Recent negative share	Total public reviews	Rating vs. 3 local peers

Overall signal severity



Public review sources: [TripAdvisor](#) · [Yelp](#) · [Google](#) · [HappyCow](#) · [Reddit](#)

Prepared by JetPakt · ReviewSentinel methodology · Every finding below is tied to a verbatim public review.

Executive snapshot

City, O' City is sitting at 3.4 stars across 1456 public reviews, with roughly 30% of recent reviews rated 1–2 stars. That puts the rating 1.03 stars below the 3-peer local benchmark (4.43 average).

The three signals driving the most guest friction right now are Service-Fee Transparency · Server Attitude & Hospitality · Pricing & Perceived Value. All are actionable inside 30–90 days without capex, and none require public apology statements.

Legal-review recommended on: Service-Fee Transparency. See flag detail in the signals section.

Estimated recovery potential

\$3,680–\$12,090	\$44,116	900–2961x
Estimated monthly recovery range	Annualized at the conservative floor	Projected ROI on the \$49 scan

Estimated from ~6,552 monthly covers at an average check of \$38 (price tier \$\$, casual category). We apply a 5% revenue lift per full star¹ and a 24% peak-hour uplift per half-star², assuming 0.1–0.2 stars of improvement inside 60–90 days after a single recommendation lands. Manager time saved on ~18 reviews/mo using defamation-safe drafts is added on top.³

Ranges, never point estimates. Recovery is conditional on executing at least one 30-day action from the plan below.

1. Luca, M. — Reviews, Reputation, and Revenue (HBS 12-016) — 5–9% revenue per star, independent restaurants; we use 5% lower bound (https://www.hbs.edu/ris/Publication%20Files/12-016_a7e4a5a2-03f9-490d-b093-8f951238dba2.pdf).

2. Anderson & Magruder (UC Berkeley) via ChowNow synthesis — 24% peak-hour uplift per half-star midpoint (<https://get.chownow.com/blog/impact-of-online-reviews-on-restaurants/>).

3. One-Haus 2025 Check Averages — QSR \$8–\$12 · casual \$28–\$52 · upscale \$55–\$95+ (<https://one-haus.com/blog/post/rising-check-averages-in-u-s-restaurants-causes-trends-and-strategies>).

Grow review volume — the compliant way

More recent reviews compound with the fixes in this scan: they improve Google local-pack ranking, smooth out the rating when a bad night happens, and give the 30/60/90 plan something to measure against. You have 1,456 lifetime reviews today — a realistic 60-day target is +12 to +25 new Google reviews at your current cover volume.

- QR card at bill drop. Print a neutral “How was it? Tell us on Google” QR on the check presenter. Given to every guest — never conditioned on a positive experience.
- Post-meal email or SMS (opt-in only). If you capture emails at reservation, send a single neutral follow-up within 24 hours linking directly to your Google Business Profile review form. Same wording for everyone; no pre-screening for satisfaction.
- Owner responses within 48 hours. Responding to reviews — positive and negative — is the single biggest signal Google associates with higher local ranking. Use the defamation-safe response templates later in this scan.
- Staff scripting, consistent across shifts. Train the FOH team on one sentence: “If you had a good time, we’d love a review on Google — no pressure either way.” No tip-linked asks. No competitions. No rewards.

- Google Business Profile hygiene. Keep hours, photos, menu link, and reservation link current. Post a weekly update. A complete profile gets asked for reviews more often by Google itself.

AVOID — these carry real penalties. Do not solicit reviews on Yelp — Yelp's software actively filters solicited reviews to the "not recommended" section, where they don't count toward your star rating¹. Do not offer discounts, free items, or contest entries in exchange for reviews — Google can remove reviews and suspend your Business Profile², and the FTC's 2024 Final Rule allows civil penalties up to \$51,744 per violation³. Do not pre-screen ("review gating") — asking only happy guests is an explicit policy violation.

1. Yelp Support — Don't Ask for Reviews — Yelp's solicitation policy and automated filter behavior (https://www.yelp-support.com/article/Don-t-Ask-for-Reviews?l=en_US).

2. Google Business Profile — Prohibited content — No selective solicitation, no incentivized reviews, no gating (<https://support.google.com/contributor/answer/7400114>).

3. FTC Final Rule on Consumer Reviews (effective Oct 21, 2024) — Bans fake, incentivized, and insider reviews; up to \$51,744 per violation (https://www.wilmerhale.com/-/media/files/shared_content/editorial/publications/wh_publications/client_alert_pdfs/20241009-ftc-finalizes-rule-banning-fake-reviews.pdf).

Top 3 quantified signals

Severity is scored 1–10 from recent negative share, review recency, and evidence density. Every signal is tied to verbatim public review text — the quotes below are the only claims this document makes.

1. Service-Fee Transparency

6.8 / 10 · MEDIUM

Category: Billing · Evidence count: 4 recent reviews

LEGAL-HIGH · Automatic gratuity / service-fee disclosure is a live regulatory topic in Denver (CCG lawsuit context). Any response touching on fee policy should route through ownership + legal review before publishing.

"Terrible, rude service. Food was below average. 20% forced gratuity. The hostess saw us come in and continued having a conversation while occasionally making bored eye contact with us. In this completely empty restaurant while still waiting to be seated she went back in the kitchen. We watched the hostess do this over and over again to other customers."

— TripAdvisor, 2023-07-13 · 1-star ([source](#))

"The last few times I was there, I've had not the best service, and one of the times, the server told me that the gratuity that's added in didn't go directly to them so I should make sure to tip her. It was just awkward and off putting."

— Reddit, 2024-08-08 · 2-star ([source](#))

2. Server Attitude & Hospitality

5.7 / 10 · MEDIUM

Category: Hospitality · Evidence count: 2 recent reviews

“Terrible, rude service. Food was below average. 20% forced gratuity. The hostess saw us come in and continued having a conversation while occasionally making bored eye contact with us. In this completely empty restaurant while still waiting to be seated she went back in the kitchen. We watched the hostess do this over and over again to other customers.”

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— Reddit, 2024-08-08 · 2-star ([source](#))

3. Pricing & Perceived Value

5.7 / 10 · MEDIUM

Category: Commercial · Evidence count: 2 recent reviews

“The service is truly hit or miss and lacks tact, respect and friendliness. If you visit the bakery next door and order a pastry to go, you're charged an extravagant service fee for the back of house. How can you keep a straight face while attempting to charge me 8 dollars and change for a brownie?”

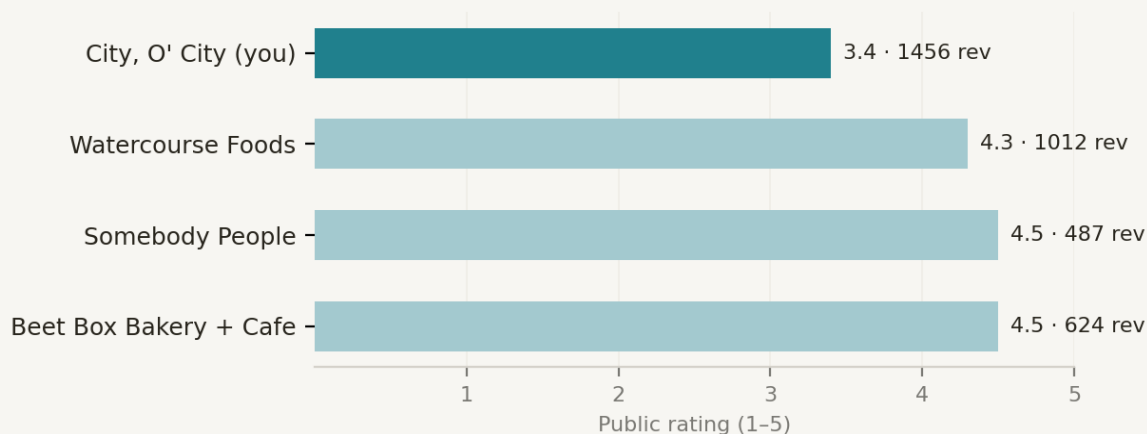
— TripAdvisor, 2023-03-13 · 2-star ([source](#))

“Pricy, BOH fee, slow service. The menu promises a lot but the execution has dropped off compared to previous years.”

— HappyCow, 2024-05-14 · 2-star ([source](#))

Local peer benchmark

Comparison against 3 nearby peer restaurants. Ratings are pulled from public review platforms (Yelp, TripAdvisor, Google). Peers are shown at reduced emphasis so your business is the focal point.



Location	Rating	Reviews	Tier
City, O' City (you)	3.4	1456	\$\$
Watercourse Foods	4.3	1012	\$\$
Somebody People	4.5	487	\$\$\$
Beet Box Bakery + Cafe	4.5	624	\$

- Watercourse Foods — [TripAdvisor](#)
- Somebody People — [Yelp](#)
- Beet Box Bakery + Cafe — [Yelp](#)

Closing half of the current 1.03-star gap against these peers is the commercial target for the next 90 days.

30 / 60 / 90-day action plan

Concrete actions mapped to the top 3 signals. Owners are role-based so the plan survives staffing changes.

First 30 days — stabilize

Owner	Action	Signal
Ownership + Legal	Audit current auto-gratuity policy language on menus, website, and check footers. Confirm Denver disclosure compliance.	Service-Fee Transparency
GM	Train staff to verbally disclose auto-grat threshold at seating for parties near the cutoff.	Service-Fee Transparency
GM	Reset the greet standard: every guest acknowledged within 60 seconds; 30-second rule for seated tables.	Server Attitude & Hospitality
GM	Daily pre-shift: one hospitality moment of the day; no-phones-on-floor policy enforced.	Server Attitude & Hospitality
GM	Audit top 10 menu items for price-to-portion perception; photo each plate against menu description.	Pricing & Perceived Value

30–60 days — systematize

Owner	Action	Signal
Ownership	Publish plain-English fee policy page on the website; link from Yelp/Google bio.	Service-Fee Transparency
GM	Mystery-diner program: 2 visits/month with a scored hospitality rubric.	Server Attitude & Hospitality
Ownership	Tie a hospitality KPI (review sentiment lift) to server performance reviews.	Server Attitude & Hospitality
Chef + GM	Introduce 2-3 visible-value items (lunch combo, happy-hour plate) to re-anchor price perception.	Pricing & Perceived Value

60–90 days — compound

Owner	Action	Signal
Ownership	Quarterly legal review of policy vs. current Denver CCG guidance.	Service-Fee Transparency
Ownership	Formal hospitality training refresh (Unreasonable Hospitality / Setting the Table frame).	Server Attitude & Hospitality
Ownership	Full menu engineering review: contribution margin vs. guest-perceived value.	Pricing & Perceived Value

Defamation – safe response drafts

Five drafts tied to the most recent lower-rated public reviews. All drafts follow three rules: acknowledge without admitting fault, move the conversation off the public thread, and avoid naming any individual staff or guest. Every draft requires human approval before publishing.

Draft 1 · TripAdvisor · 2023-07-13 · 1-star

“Terrible, rude service. Food was below average. 20% forced gratuity. The hostess saw us come in and continued having a conversation while occasionally making bored eye contact with us. In this completely empty restaurant while still waiting to be seated she went back in the kitchen. We watched the hostess do this over and over again to other customers.”

[Review source](#)

LEGAL-HIGH · Automatic gratuity / service-fee disclosure is a live regulatory topic in Denver (CCG lawsuit context). Any response touching on fee policy should route through ownership + legal review before publishing.

Suggested response:

Thank you for the feedback. We want our fee and auto-gratuity policy to be fully clear at the table, and your note is helping us re-review how we communicate it. If you'd like to discuss your specific visit, please contact us at hello@cityocitydenver.com.

Status: HOLD — requires human approval before publishing

Draft 2 · Reddit · 2024-08-08 · 2-star

“The last few times I was there, I've had not the best service, and one of the times, the server told me that the gratuity that's added in didn't go directly to them so I should make sure to tip her. It was just awkward and off putting.”

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Draft 3 · TripAdvisor · 2023-03-13 · 2-star

“The service is truly hit or miss and lacks tact, respect and friendliness. If you visit the bakery next door and order a pastry to go, you're charged an extravagant service fee for the back of house. How can you keep a straight face while attempting to charge me 8 dollars and change for a brownie?”

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Draft 4 · TripAdvisor · 2023-07-06 · 2-star

“Food was mediocre. Burger was too dry, tomatoes were mealy, a measly limp slice of romaine. Jerk cauliflower just okay. Poor presentation as well as taste. Never again.”

[Review source](#)

Suggested response:

We appreciate you letting us know — this is not the standard we hold ourselves to on these dishes. The team is re-tasting and checking our build specs this week. If you're open to it, reach us at hello@cityocitydenver.com and we'll make your next visit right.

Status: HOLD — requires human approval before publishing

Draft 5 · HappyCow · 2024-05-14 · 2-star

“Pricy, BOH fee, slow service. The menu promises a lot but the execution has dropped off compared to previous years.”

[Review source](#)

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Where this can go next

This document is the \$49 One-Time Scan. JetPakt also runs continuous monitoring, multi-location dashboards, and workflow-integrated reputation operations.

Plan	Price	What's included
One-Time Scan	\$49	Snapshot + checklist (this document).
Monthly Essentials	\$99/mo	Ongoing sentiment monitoring across Yelp, Google, TripAdvisor.
Weekly Insights	\$199/mo	Deeper analysis, priority-ranked plans, trend alerts.
Multi-Location	from \$399/mo	Cross-site dashboards for groups and operators.
Enterprise Integration	Custom	API access, automation, governance, SSO.

Ready to move to Monthly Essentials or run this on another location? Reach Ryan B. at gojetpakt.us@outlook.com or 303-549-1697.

About the methodology

JetPakt ReviewSentinel pulls verbatim public review text, maps each excerpt to a controlled signal taxonomy, and scores severity from recent negative share × recency × evidence density. No individuals are named in generated body copy. Reviewer first names may appear inside verbatim quotes because they belong to the reviewer, not the business. Response drafts are generated from templates and always require human approval before publication. Legal-flagged signals (service fees, food safety, billing disputes) should be routed through ownership and legal review prior to any public response.